PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #70 · ABUSE

“Other people had it worse, so what was done to me doesn’t really count.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Comparison is a way to keep going: “Other people had it worse, so mine doesn’t count.” Sometimes other people said that to silence you. Minimizing can feel humble or tough. It is still a lie if it means your harm does not matter, you should not need help, and you should not tell. Someone else’s deeper pain does not shrink yours. God does not run a contest before He binds up the brokenhearted. You do not have to prove your story was the worst in order for it to count. If you are not safe right now, call 911. You can also call the National Domestic Violence Hotline at 1-800-799-7233. If a child is being hurt, call Childhelp at 1-800-422-4453. A counselor can help you at a pace that is safe. You do not have to do this alone, or all at once.

What Scripture teaches

God binds up the brokenhearted. He does not first ask whether someone else was broken more. He is near the brokenhearted, not only the people with the most visible wounds. We weep with those who weep, without a scoreboard. We carry one another’s burdens, including burdens the person has been told are too small. Your pain can be real and still not be the worst pain in the world. Both of those things are true.

> *“The Spirit of the Lord GOD is on Me, because the LORD has anointed Me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent Me to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives and freedom to the prisoners”* (Isaiah 61:1).

Also see

> “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds” (Psalm 147:3).
>
> “The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit” (Psalm 34:18).
>
> “Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep” (Romans 12:15).
>
> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

Common self-statements

- I should be over it because others had it worse.
- Complaining would be selfish.
- It was not that bad.
- If I get help, I am taking it from someone who needs it more.
- I have no right to call it abuse.
- God is busy with bigger suffering.

Common logical errors

- Minimization: Shrinking real harm because it is not the worst imaginable harm.
- All-or-nothing thinking: If it is not the worst, it does not count at all.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling you should be fine, and deciding you are fine.
- Discounting the positive: Refusing help, comfort, or the name of what happened.

Challenging questions

- Who benefits if I decide my harm does not count?
- Would I tell a friend their pain was too small to matter?
- What do I lose by never naming it?
- Can two people need help at the same time?
- What does God do with a broken heart that is not the most broken?
- What is one help I have refused because I thought I should be grateful?

Truth summary

> What was done to me counts, even if someone else suffered more. I am allowed to get help without winning a comparison.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

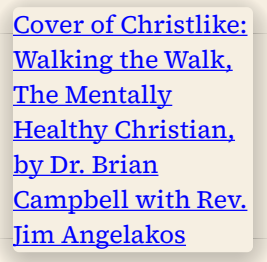
- Sorrow
- Guilt/Shame
- Thinking, Healthy
- Help
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Suffering
- Grief
- Thinking, Healthy

What does a mentally healthy Christian look like?



From *Christlike: Walking the Walk* by Dr. Brian Campbell. A portrait, verse by verse, of how a mentally healthy Christian thinks, feels, and lives.

Read excerpts from "The Mentally Healthy Christian" (with every Scripture written out)

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
God's care for you does not depend on your pain winning a comparison.

This Is Amazing Grace — Phil Wickham
Grace meets your actual hurt. It does not ask you to rank it.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
You are allowed to heal and live, not only to endure because someone else had more.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
God is great enough to care for your wound and for everyone else's.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, what is one step I could take today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Other people had it worse, so what was done to me doesn't really count."

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Other people had it worse, so what was done to me doesn't really count." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who benefits if I decide my harm does not count?
- ☐ Would I tell a friend their pain was too small to matter?
- ☐ What do I lose by never naming it?
- ☐ Can two people need help at the same time?
- ☐ What does God do with a broken heart that is not the most broken?
- ☐ What is one help I have refused because I thought I should be grateful?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ What was done to me counts, even if someone else suffered more. I am allowed to get help without winning a comparison.
- ☐ My pain does not have to be the worst to be real.
- ☐ God binds up my broken heart without a contest.
- ☐ Minimizing kept me quiet. It does not have to keep me from help.
- ☐ I can care about others and still name my own hurt.
- ☐ I do not owe anyone a graphic comparison.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Isaiah 61:1
  "The Spirit of the Lord GOD is on Me, because the LORD has anointed Me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent Me to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives and freedom to the prisoners."
- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."
- ☐ Psalm 34:18
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."

A verse I found myself:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When you ranked your pain as too small: Each day, write down one moment when you decided your harm did not count. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Isaiah 61:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God binds up the brokenhearted. That includes me, even if someone else suffered more.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Sorrow" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone. If you are not safe right now, call 911 or 1-800-799-7233.

- [ ] Drop the contest. Write "It counts" under the sentence "others had it worse." Do not list details or other people's stories.
- [ ] Ask for one help you have postponed because you thought you should cope: a counselor, a friend, or 1-800-799-7233.
- [ ] Tell your counselor you minimize. Let them help you name the impact without a graphic account.
- [ ] If a child is being minimized or hurt, call 1-800-422-4453 or 911. Their pain counts too.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Other people had it worse, so what was done to me doesn't really count.": _____ %

My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment my pain was allowed to count
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Other people had it worse, so what was done to me doesn't really count~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have treated my harm as if it did not count. You bind up the brokenhearted, including me. Help me receive care without winning a comparison. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.